EXAM SHIELD

PHP Question Bank

Server-side PHP: syntax, forms, security and tooling.

13 questions: 8 multiple choice, 3 fill in the gap and 2 written. Total 18 marks.
Edition: with answers (staff copy, ready to import into Exam Shield).

How this paper is laid out

Questions are numbered in one sequence. Multiple-choice options are lettered with a full stop; each multiple-choice question is worth one mark unless stated.

Fill-in-the-gap questions show each blank as a line; they earn one mark per blank, shown in square brackets, and are marked automatically.

Written questions show their marks in square brackets and are marked by an examiner.

To use this paper in Exam Shield, open an exam, choose Questions and then Import from PDF, and upload this file. Review the preview and import.

Section 1: PHP

Server-side PHP: syntax, forms, security and tooling.

1. Which character begins every variable name in PHP?

A. @
B. $
C. #
D. &

Answer: B

2. Which superglobal holds data submitted by an HTML form using the POST method?

A. $_POST
B. $_FORM
C. $_SERVER
D. $_GET

Answer: A

3. Which operator joins two strings in PHP?

A. . (dot)
B. ++ (increment)
C. + (plus)
D. & (ampersand)

Answer: A

4. Which function checks that a variable exists and is not null?

A. isset()
B. is_null()
C. empty()
D. defined()

Answer: A

5. What is the correct way to prevent SQL injection when using PDO?

A. Calling addslashes() on input
B. Running strip_tags() on input
C. Hashing the input with md5()
D. Prepared statements with bound parameters

Answer: D

6. Which tool manages PHP project dependencies?

A. npm
B. pip
C. Maven
D. Composer

Answer: D

7. Which function should be used to hash user passwords?

A. password_hash()
B. md5()
C. base64_encode()
D. sha1()

Answer: A

8. What does echo 10 <=> 5; print?

A. 1
B. 0
C. -1
D. true

Answer: A

9. In PHP, the superglobal that holds URL query-string parameters is _____. [1 mark]

Answer: $_GET

10. The PHP function that converts an array into a JSON string is _____. [1 mark]

Answer: json_encode / json_encode()

11. To check a login password against a hash made by password_hash(), PHP code calls _____. [1 mark]

Answer: password_verify / password_verify()

12. Explain the difference between include and require in PHP. [3 marks]

13. What are PHP sessions? List two measures that keep session data secure. [4 marks]